



Mood of the Nation **BEST CHIEF MINISTERS**

Leaders and LAGGARDS

Fresh from her third consecutive victory in Delhi, Sheila Dikshit moves up to second position while Modi remains No. 1 for the third successive year

By Ashok K. Damodaran

When it comes to politics, it doesn't matter if you are a man or woman, illiterate or educated, urban or rural, old or young, Hindu or Muslim, upper caste or Dalit. Everybody has an opinion and everyone believes he or she is right. Narendra Modi is not among the dozen or so men and women who barely conceal their prime ministerial ambitions but if a political version of "Indian Idol" were to be chosen, irrespective of these divides, the Gujarat chief minister is likely to win hands down. Since 2002, when INDIA TODAY and pollsters AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG broadened the scope of the Mood of the Nation poll to assess the performance of chief ministers across the country, Modi has always been rated among the five best chief ministers in the country. In our last three polls, he has held the number one slot and this year, with a nationwide approval rating of 20, Modi polled almost as much as the first and second runners-up, Sheila Dikshit (11) and Nitish Kumar (10), put together.

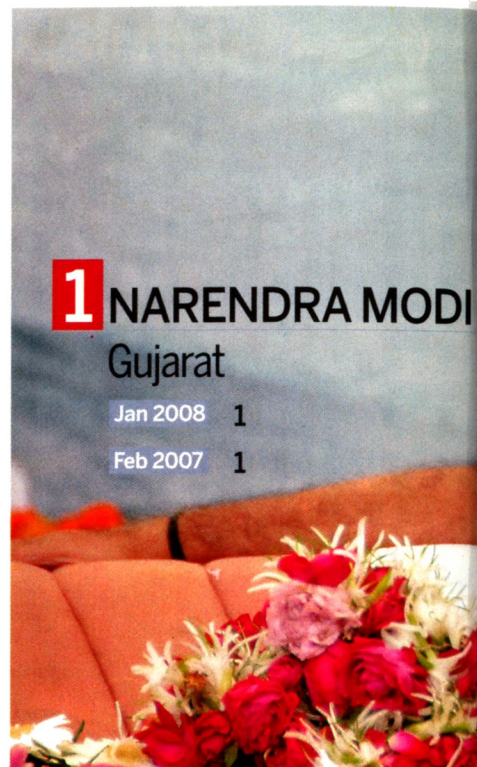
For the 15th Mood of the Nation poll, 12,374 voters in 19 states were asked to rate the performance of the chief ministers of their own states as well as their perceptions about the chief ministers of other states. Though chief ministerial writ does not extend beyond the boundaries of the respective states, some like Modi have come to acquire a pan-Indian image. That Modi's approval rating is a phenomenal 80 per cent in his home state should come as no surprise, but what is truly astounding is that across several states, he has got

PROMINENT GAINERS

Sheila Dikshit
Shivraj Chouhan
Nitish Kumar
V.S. Achuthanandan

Mayawati
YSR Reddy
Parkash S. Badal
Naveen Patnaik

PROMINENT LOSERS



1 NARENDRA MODI

Gujarat

Jan 2008 1

Feb 2007 1

SIPRA DAS



2 SHEILA DIKSHIT

Delhi

Jan 2008 5

Feb 2007 5